7.1.1 Definition and Concept of Family Resource Management

Resources can be defined as anything we use to achieve what we want (our goals). In other words, they are the materials and human attributes which satisfy our wants.

The concept of management involves planned use of resources directed towards the achievement of desired ends. This involves the weighing of values and the making of series of decisions.

Home management is the vital factor in every family contributing to the overall health, happiness and well-being and higher standard of living for the family members. In simpler terms, home management is defined as the mental process of utilising the available resources to achieve what you want in life.

Figure - 1 indicates that **management is a process involving activities, through which action is initiated and resources are used for achieving a goal**. For this purpose, certain guidelines in the form of values, goals and standards can be formulated by every manager. For sure attainment of desired goals it becomes essential to plan, organise, coordinate and control all the activities, so that the resources are not wasted.

Management Process:

Management process consists of five steps 1) Planning 2) Organizing 3) Directing. 4) Controlling 5) Evaluating and are discussed below in detail.

1. Planning

Planning is very important to the success of management process. It is basically working out ways or course of action to achieve the goals. Planning can be habitual or conscious.

Planning involves thinking through the possible ways of reaching a desired goal. It also involves developing a sequence of actions within an overall organizational structure.



The entire task from beginning to its completion must be viewed in whole. If the paths leading to the goals are easy to see, the choice of the best plan can be made quickly. When the path is hard to see due to some obstacle, the planner must find ways of overcoming them. As children do not have enough experience, they can get the help of an experienced adult to plan. The final act in planning is arriving at a decision. **'It is the gate that releases action'.**

Good planning requires the use of the powers of thinking, memory, observation, reasoning and imagination. These powers, make it easier to plan and to meet situations in everyday living. For example the following points should be borne in mind while planning a birthday party.

Chapter7_156-184.indd 157 31-01-2019 15:24:35